

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

or other items or even money. Once we really figure out what it is that we need, what we find is that many of us can actually live on . . . less.'

That hedonic treadmill again. When we see similar themes crop up in each step of the journey towards financial wellbeing, I like to think that it demonstrates the strength of this approach, and how each of the steps, even as they follow on from one another, are interlinked and contributing to a bigger picture of financial health and general wellbeing. Whichever way you cut the cake, the layers are the same, and the work that Aja does spans far wider than money or personal wellbeing – it helps us to see how our actions impact society and the planet that is our only home too.

I asked Aja whether there was a penny-drop moment for her, and whether there were any pointers she could share for anyone else looking to re-evaluate their relationship with consumerism.

'One year I added up my receipts from one fast fashion store that I used to frequent. I was HORRIFIED by the amount I was spending,' she said. 'Coupled with the knowledge I was beginning to grasp about garment worker treatment and environmental damage, I knew then and there that I had to make a change. None of these purchases were "harmless" and as I grasped the impact, I began to feel quite frustrated that I hadn't seen it sooner. Of course, it's always an ongoing process for me. It's not a clean break at all because consumerism is